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Sell

CHINA MERCHANTS PROP OPERATION (001914.SZ)

Weak shareholder return outlook and asset impairment risk overhang; downgrade to Sell

We downgrade CMPO to Sell from Neutral given low visibility on both growth and improvement in shareholder return, alongside lingering IP write down risks:

- **Shareholder returns** appear to be less of a focus compared to the rest of coverage PMs, with no indication of a plan to raise the dividend payout ratio beyond the current level of c.30%, placing CMPO's dividend yield (3%) at the lowest level for the coming three years among our coverage universe (average 6-7%).
- **IP write down risks** aggravating amid macro adversities, which could overshadow the company's profitability stabilization. CMPO is the most "asset-heavy" property manager among our coverage universe, with Rmb5.5bn of investment properties sitting on its balance sheet, equivalent to 27% of CMPO's 1Q26 total assets. These assets, consisting of hotels, malls, offices, apartments and leasable public buildings with aggregate GFA of over 0.6mn sqm, have seen weakening occupancy rates (-2pp yoy in FY25) and rental income generation (-4% yoy, vs. CMPO's overall topline +12% in FY25). We expect unfavorable rental reversion and occupancy pressure due to low consumer confidence and macro headwinds, potentially leading to steeper fair value losses (vs. Rmb19mn in FY25) going ahead.
- **Margin likely under pressure:** we expect CMPO's PMS GPM consistently to stay behind the peer average level by c.5pp for years and is unlikely to catch up considering 1) limited cash collection efforts spent so far; and 2) non-residential space offering limited pricing power against government customers and SOE affiliates. As such, we lower GPM forecasts by an average 0.3pp in 2026E-28E to average 9.7% vs. 10.4% in FY25, and cut our 2026E-28E earnings estimates by an average 5% to 6% CAGR. Our net profit forecasts are now on average 7% below Wind consensus.

Revise our 12m TP to Rmb9.4 (from Rmb11.7), based on a 13X (from prior 15X) 2028E FCF discounted back to 2026E with a 9.7% CoE, after we added a 10% discount to the company's L-T multiple to reflect the aforementioned IP asset impairment risk (vs. 10% credit discount that we applied to CGS and Onewo due to affiliated developer risks and nil discount to the rest of coverage). Correspondingly,

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our TP suggests 4% upside against PM coverage average of 24%. **Downgrade to Sell from Neutral.** CMPO trades at 10X/10X/9X 2026E-28E P/Es against a 6% EPS CAGR plus 3% yield vs. our PM coverage at 11X/9X/9X against a 10% EPS CAGR plus 7% yield. We could turn more positive on the company if we were to see **1)** greater focus on shareholder returns (more generous dividend policy or the utilization of channels such as share buybacks) from management; **2)** downward margin trend easing on the back of portfolio optimization and effective cost saving; **3)** broader macroeconomic and consumer confidence recovery alleviating IP write down risks, or strong execution in heavy asset disposal.

Key risks: **1)** Scale growth beat due to stronger-than-expected 3P projects engagements especially in the non-residential sphere on the back of group-level synergies or broader property sector recovery. **2)** Faster-than-expected specialized value-added-services development (e.g. housekeeping services, NEV charging station, real estate brokerage, etc.) driven by broad-based consumption recovery, resulting in stronger-than-expected topline; **3)** More resilient-than-expected margin profile through more effective cost-control initiatives, efficient technological empowerment and digitalization, rising project density/scale effect, broader economic/labor market recovery and consumer confidence pick-up, etc.

001914.SZ	12m Price Target: Rmb9.4	Price: Rmb9.05	Upside: 3.9%		
Sell	GS Forecast				
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: Rmb9.5bn / \$1.4bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	19,273.2	20,503.7	21,786.0	22,909.4
Enterprise value: Rmb4.0bn / \$593.0mn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	19,273.2	20,503.7	21,786.0	22,909.4
3m ADTV: Rmb74.8mn / \$11.0mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	1,245.0	1,353.9	1,369.4	1,407.7
China	EPS (Rmb) New	0.62	0.89	0.93	0.96
China Property Services	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.62	0.91	0.98	1.03
	P/E (X)	18.5	10.1	9.7	9.4
M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	1.1	0.8	0.8	0.7
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Dividend yield (%)	2.3	3.0	3.1	3.2
	CROCI (%)	28.7	27.0	29.0	26.8
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.30	0.34	0.29	(0.04)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 20 Jul 2026 close.

Investment Thesis

CMPO is a diversified PM with the support from SOE parent CM Shekou to capture both residential/non-residential opportunities. We are Sell rated on the company as we see low visibility on growth and shareholder return improvement, alongside lingering IP write down risks. Shareholder returns appear to be less of a focus for CMPO vs peers and a persistently conservative dividend payout ratio places its dividend yield at the lowest level of our coverage universe for the coming three years. We also see IP write down risks, with CMPO as the most “asset-heavy” property manager among peers, carrying investment properties equivalent to nearly 30% of total assets but with a somewhat mixed track record in commercial operation, and this could lead to earnings downside amid macro adversities. We also believe CMPO needs some more time to catch up with peers in terms of PMS margin and specialized services development. The company currently trades at similar valuation to the peer average yet with lower EPS CAGR and a dividend yield at half the peer average.

Price Target, Risks and Methodology

Our 12-month target price of Rmb9.4 is based on 13X 2028E FCF discounted back to 2026E with a 9.7% CoE.

Key risks: 1) Scale growth beat due to stronger-than-expected 3P project engagements on the back of group-level synergies or property sector recovery. 2) Faster-than-expected specialized value-added-services development. 3) Upbeat margin profile due to effective cost control initiatives.

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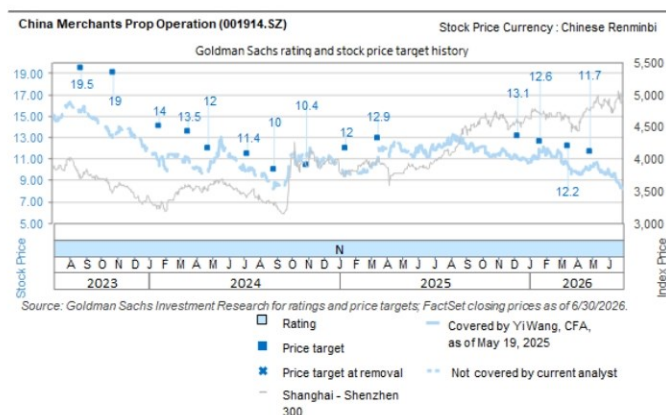
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Target price history table(s)

China Merchants Prop Operation (001914.SZ)

Date of report Target price (Rmb) Closing price (Rmb)

28-Apr-26	11.70	10.12
16-Mar-26	12.20	10.38
23-Jan-26	12.60	11.75
11-Dec-25	13.10	11.06
17-Mar-25	12.90	11.92
13-Jan-25	12.00	9.79
31-Oct-24	10.40	11.56
30-Aug-24	10.00	8.79
10-Jul-24	11.40	9.42
26-Apr-24	12.00	10.12
18-Mar-24	13.50	10.95
22-Jan-24	14.00	10.23
27-Oct-23	19.00	13.53
25-Aug-23	19.50	15.63

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